

Russell Dudek

Chief Operating Officer · AI-Enabled Operations & Delivery

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn emerging technology into adopted, measurable outcomes. Brings current AI-first operating transformation, distributed operations, high-velocity customer promises, quality systems, engineering/manufacturing depth, commercial modernization, and direct agentic-workflow design.

Operating cadence	AI-enabled workflow design	Distributed teams	Delivery systems	Quality & escalation	CRM / ERP integration	Customer outcomes	Lean / Gemba
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VAPE-JET

2025-Present

Director of Operations

- Lead an AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connect factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Operate in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.
- Build recurring leadership rhythms, escalation paths, root-cause mechanisms, and cross-functional visibility across hardware, software, operations, customers, and support.

DUDEWORTH

2017-Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develop AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Design agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advise on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

AMAZON

2014-2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms across safety, quality, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Served on the Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

OPERATING THESIS FOR THIS ROLE

Connect what is sold to what can be scoped, staffed, delivered, proven, renewed, and converted into healthy margin and cash - while treating AI agents as managed capacity with human authority.

PROFESSIONAL-SERVICES OPERATING FOCUS

Engagement portfolio

Promise, scope, capacity, delivery risk, outcome evidence, renewal, and owner.

Business rhythm

Scorecards, forecasts, margin and cash visibility, escalation thresholds, and decision records.

Blended capacity

People and agents with defined jobs, human authority, evaluation, cost, release posture, and learning.

COMPUNETICS

2000-2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management · progressive roles

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls connecting technical and operating teams.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD; published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

CARDINAL BUILDING PRODUCTS

2021-2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Connected sales activity, customer needs, fulfillment, and transportation-planning concepts across a geographically distributed environment.

ZEUSVU

2018-2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone-delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP

Enviro Social Capital · Chairman of the Board, 2014-2017: co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative; helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept.

IEEE · Pittsburgh Chapter Chair, 2012-2016: led regional programming connecting industry, academia, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

TECHNOLOGY & METHODS

Agentic AI · LLM workflows · RAG · human-in-the-loop · Python · SQL · JavaScript · TensorFlow · Tableau · Odoo · Jira · Confluence · HubSpot · Slack · GIS · telemetry · Lean · Six Sigma · Gemba · standard work · QMS

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science · chemistry, materials-science, physical-chemistry, and biology-related grounding

Academic work indexed through Google Scholar.

SELECTED CREDENTIALS

Google AI Essentials · Food Safety Management Certification · IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner · Six Sigma Certification · OSHA 10

OPERATING SYSTEMS I REPEATEDLY BUILD		
Cross-functional cadence	Customer-to-work handoffs	Quality and root cause
Written remote execution	AI evaluation and governance	Closed-loop learning

ROLE-SPECIFIC VALUE

Operate the company.
Cadence, visibility, escalation, quality, staffing logic, systems integration, and disciplined follow-through.

Manage AI as work.
Give agents defined jobs, owners, human authority, evaluation, escalation, cost, release posture, and learning loops.

Protect the promise.
Connect sales, delivery, proof, renewal, margin, and cash through one operating truth.